

Kim, John, and I arrived a little early and parked in the dark and waited.

The sky was amazingly clear and I got out of the car to look up and enjoy the view. Meanwhile, my two carmates...



Our other two stalwart participants arrived and we set about getting ready.



At 5:40 am we set out in complete darkness down the trail. By this time the clouds were starting to be covered by a cloud layer which didn't bode well for getting a decent view from any of the peaks but which did raise the chance the weather would get interesting.

We climbed the first peak, San Gabriel, in total darkness



We were up on the first peak, San Gabriel, before the sun was even up. We did have a nice view of the brightening skyline between the ground and the rather oppressive clouds which had rolled in.



The sun made a very brief appearance but wasn't out long enough for me to even bother getting my sunglasses out.



View of our planned last peak, Hoyt.









We huddled under some brush and quickly put on our rain gear.







We made our way up Occidental which was the peak that derailed our previous attempt at this hike several months ago. This time instead of doing a cross country route that was written up in the mid-70s we did the usual route along a fence line.



The first third of the hike is literally going along the fence line surrounding some radio towers.



These friendly signs greet you every 20 or 30 feet.



Periodically we could look over the ridge and catch sight of LA.



The peak itself is rather unremarkable. There was no peak log (yet again) and hardly enough room for all of us to sit. As we still had 5 more peaks to go we only stayed long enough to get a picture and then we headed back.



The next peak was Mount Wilson, site of the Wilson Observatory. This was a drive-up peak, something I don't usually like to do but in this case I made an exception. So, we parked in one of the visitor lots, pulled out my trusty GPS, and walked 200 feet to where I showed the highest point. Behold, the snack bar:



Now we were down to three more peaks and of those only the last was going to be a real workout. We decided to hit Vetter next which is the site of a fire lookout that belongs to the same organization that Kim and I volunteer with on Tahquitz.

As we drove up the Angeles highway it started to rain again, a little more heavily this time. The dirt road to the lookout was still passable in our two low clearance cars and we started up a blocked dirt road already wearing our rain gear.





It didn't really start coming down until we were almost to the tower



Bob the Towerman seemed rather surprised to see us considering it was around 4 pm and raining hard. We ducked inside the tower and chatter for a bit. He seemed to consider the group of us crazy for being out hiking in this mess.

We were all huddling in the tower out of the rain when Kim apparently decided it was time to go and took off into the rain. We made hasty goodbyes and followed her out into what turned out to be the hardest rain of the day.



We had waterproof jackets on but our boots and our pants became completely soaked.



When we got back to the car Jim and Gigi decided that was it for them. They left in Jim's car while the three of us continued to the 10th peak, Mooney.



Mooney is another one of those unimpressive peaks that doesn't even have a decent hike to get there. We basically drove up a dirt road, parked, and walked up a jeep trail a few hundred feet.



It was still raining off and on though not as hard as before.

